(7) The opposition parties and the Rajya Sabha can now play a greater role in exercising financial control over the executive.

The DRSC system has influenced the functioning of the executive in a significant manner. The recommendations made by the DRSCs have been of immense importance. It has been found that the ministries/department within the purview of these committees have been quite receptive to their recommendations and have, by and large, accepted them and initiated suitable action for their implementation. There have been very few instances where the ministries/departments have convincingly expressed their inability to implement the recommendations of the committees[7].

The DRSCs have made parliamentary debates better informed by nourishing the information supply system. The effectiveness of these committees can be judged on four yardsticks, namely, (i) their success in holding officials to account, (ii) publication of information, (iii) their effect on the House and the wider public, and (iv) their influence on government's decisions. Going by any of the criteria, one can emphatically say that DRSCs have proved their worth. The activities of these committees have created a "corpus of knowledge" for members of the Parliament and public, which otherwise would not have been possible. The discussion and debates in such committees and the reports they produce further sharpen government policies[8].

COMMITTEES TO INQUIRE

 **Committee on Petitions**

This committee examines petitions on bills and on matters of general public importance. It also entertains representations from individuals and associations on matters pertaining to Union subjects. The Lok Sabha committee consists of 15 members, while the Rajya Sabha committee consists of 10 members.

 **Committee of Privileges**

The functions of this committee are semi-judicial in nature. It examines the cases of breach of privileges of the House and its members and recommends appropriate action. The Lok Sabha committee has 15 members, while the Rajya Sabha committee has 10 members.

 **Ethics Committee**

This committee was constituted in Rajya Sabha in 1997 and in Lok Sabha in 2000. It enforces the code of conduct of members of Parliament. It examines the cases of misconduct and recommends appropriate action. Thus, it is engaged in maintaining discipline and decorum in Parliament. The Lok Sabha committee has 15 members, while the Rajya Sabha committees has 10 members.

COMMITTEES TO SCRUTINISE AND CONTROL

 **Committee on Government Assurances**